
Handout, Privacy and opsec (one page)

The full version is the

[opsec handout for activists and journalists.](#)

This page is the short reminder to keep in your pocket.

Remember one thing

Bitcoin is pseudonymous, not anonymous. The blockchain is public and permanent. Your name is not on it, but careless habits can reveal you. Privacy is practised, not assumed.

Seven habits

1. Never reuse an address (let the wallet make a new one each time).
2. Never share a screenshot, your balance, or your xpub.
3. Keep separate wallets: donations, spending, savings.
4. Use Lightning for small and frequent payments.
5. Protect the phone: lock, PIN, updates, a clean device for sensitive work.
6. Public fundraising: pseudonym plus a Lightning address, never a live balance.
7. Custody: paper or metal seed, two safe places, multisig for group money.

The golden rule

If anyone asks for your seed phrase or private key, it is a scam. Every time.

Watch for

- Fake wallet links and "restore your wallet" messages.
- "Double your Bitcoin" and guaranteed returns.
- One phone holding a whole group's funds.

If a device is seized or someone is detained

- Group funds use multisig, so one phone cannot move them.
- Follow the [team safety protocol](#).
- Contact your country lead and legal aid. Plan this before you need it.

The boundary

This is not about breaking the law or hiding a crime. It is about keeping the ability to organise, report and survive when money is used against people. Check what is legal where you are.